



Unsafe Buildings Authority Meeting July 20th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5rKnsWyM2iU
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting with procedural business and roll call [00:01:19](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Commissioner Rean (referred to as Sherry/Commissioner Reagan), Commissioner Henry, and a third commissioner/board member.
 - **Staff Present:** Tom (Building Commissioner), Jeremy, and Kylan.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named, but led by the board commissioners.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:01:04](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- **00:05:28 Motion & Approval:** A motion was made and seconded to approve the prior meeting minutes as submitted. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote **00:05:32**.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:36 Item 1: Unsafe Structure – 7513 North State Road 3 (Chad McKibben)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom, Building Commissioner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The property is an abandoned, falling-down unsafe structure containing barrels of unknown contents (IDEM notified). The next-door neighbor expressed support for its removal.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote **00:04:51**. Property owner is given 15 days to pull permits; otherwise, the county will secure bids to demolish the structure and place a lien on the property.
- **00:05:46 Item 2: Unsafe Structure & Debris – 714 South Lancaster (Tucker Jent)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom, Building Commissioner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The main structure was torn down a couple of years ago, but the site was left piled with debris alongside an accessory structure (garage) that was never rebuilt. The property is reportedly behind on taxes and the yard remains unmaintained.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:07:18**. Owner is given 15 days to remove debris and tear down the remaining garage, failing which the county will secure bids and place a lien.
- **00:07:35 Item 3: Unsafe Structure/Mobile Home – 7901 East Pinbrook (Randall Bell / Stephen Bell)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom, Building Commissioner / Stephen Bell (Property Owner's Son).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Stephen Bell appeared to explain that he was out of town working for two years, leading to property neglect, but has recently returned and is clearing brush with his father using an excavator. He requested time to remove the trailer and rebuild the garage.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Stephen Bell (resident/owner) stated he is actively cleaning up the property and requested 90 days.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:12:20**. Granted 60 days of progress monitoring, requiring an update at the August 17th commissioners' meeting. If unremoved, the county will solicit demolition bids and place a lien.
- **00:14:06 Item 4 & 5: Unsafe Properties – 105 South Lancaster & 7710 East Pinbrook (James Greer)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom, Building Commissioner / James Greer (Property Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** 105 South Lancaster is heavily deteriorated. The owner, James Greer, explained he inherited the properties and is selling them at a loss to an LLC (Midstate Property Solutions / Brock King) to avoid code penalties, with a

closing scheduled for August 27. Board members expressed concern regarding “predatory” property buyers who acquire tax-delinquent or distressed county properties without maintaining them.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** James Greer (owner) explained the emotional and financial difficulty of managing the properties.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:29:27](#). Motion requires the owner to keep the yards mowed and weeds cut between now and the August 27 sale date, and requires the buyer (Midstate Property Solutions) to contact the building commissioner.
- [00:30:31](#) **Item 6: Unsafe Structure & Property – 712 West County Road 600 South (Richard McCrae)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom, Building Commissioner / Richard McCrae (Property Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The house is vacant and overgrown. The owner, a military veteran working 60 hours a week, stated a contractor took his money without mowing, but claimed he has recently cleaned the front and removed a junk car. Board members noted the property has strong potential for family housing if rehabilitated.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Richard McCrae (owner) apologized for the condition and committed to continuing cleanup and turning utilities back on.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:36:11](#). Owner must continue progress, keep the yard mowed, turn electricity back on, and coordinate with the building commissioner.
- [00:38:46](#) **Item 7: Unsafe Property & Court Proceedings – 904 South Whitney Road (Samantha Wright)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom, Building Commissioner and Jeremy.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Severe hazardous conditions including massive trash piles, animal control/DCS involvement (children and animals removed), bypassed electrical wiring running through standing urine, and active unlawful re-occupancy by the owner. A court hearing is scheduled for July 30 to seek permanent removal and clean-up/demolition.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote [00:44:12](#) to authorize professional clean-up and demolition pending the outcome of the July 30 court hearing.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:48:07](#) **Rick Hammond (Hide Park Resident):** Addressed the board regarding neighborhood-led revitalization efforts in Hide Park. He noted that residents have begun adopting vacant lots, mowing, and organizing a neighborhood cleanup scheduled for the

upcoming weekend. The board and building commissioner commended Mr. Hammond and participating neighbors for their proactive engagement.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Updates provided on ongoing compliance cases, including 8050 South US Highway 35 (rehabbed successfully by Phillips Property Investors), 251 West Mount Pleasant Boulevard (state construction release received), and Foundry Row Apartments (framing/drywall underway, targeting late 2023/early 2024 completion).
- Discussion regarding draft grass, weed, and vehicle ordinances slated for introduction on August 3rd, alongside an on-call mowing RFP funded by the commissioners.
- General discussion on county housing shortages, rural residential development, infrastructure costs, and partnering with local builders.

- **Adjournment:**

- **00:14:06 Motion & Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to adjourn the unsafe building meeting. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote **00:14:13**.

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